



FREE GUIDE · FOR PHYSICIAN OFFICES

The Physician Office's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Sharps, vaccines, meds, and red-bag waste —
every regulated stream, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

More regulated waste than you think.

A physician office generates several regulated streams — injection and blood-draw sharps, expired medications and vaccines, red-bag biohazard, and sometimes controlled substances. Each is governed by a different rule, and everyday habits (a sharps container left to overfill, a vaccine tossed in the trash) are the ones inspectors catch. Here's every stream and the simplest compliant way to handle it.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can take your sharps, meds, and biohazard — by prepaid mail-back kit, with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Sharps

Your highest-frequency stream — injections, blood draws, and minor procedures.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles, syringes & lancets
- Blood-draw & IV sharps
- Scalpel blades & suture needles

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line and keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired and unused non-controlled medications and vaccines.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired vaccines & antibiotics
- Non-controlled injectables & samples
- Topicals & oral meds

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Keep any hazardous or controlled drugs separate — they each have their own path.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Blood- and fluid-soaked materials and contaminated PPE.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze & dressings
- Contaminated PPE
- Specimen & culture waste

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, and retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — over-classifying wastes money.

WASTE STREAM 04

Controlled substances

If your office stocks or samples Schedule II–V drugs.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V
- Wasted or partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, complete a DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, and keep witnessed waste logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The physician-office compliance checklist.

- ☐ Sharps in FDA-cleared containers, replaced at the fill line.
- ☐ Expired meds & vaccines segregated and destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Red-bag biohazard labeled, stored securely, and destroyed.

- ☐ Any controlled substances rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS PHYSICIANS ASK

Your questions, answered.

How do we dispose of expired vaccines?

As pharmaceutical waste — in a pharmaceutical-waste kit, destroyed with documentation. Never the regular trash.

What counts as red-bag biohazard vs regular trash?

Only items visibly soaked or caked with blood/OPIM are red-bag. Lightly soiled everyday items usually aren't — check your state's definition.

Do we need controlled-substance disposal if we only sample?

If you stock or sample any Schedule II–V drug, expired or wasted stock must be destroyed non-retrievable with a Form 41.

How often do we replace sharps containers?

At the fill line — about three-quarters full. Never overfill.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums; auto-ship available.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits sized to a physician office — fill, seal, and mail them back. We destroy the contents at our DEA-registered facility and return a Certificate of Destruction. No pickups, no route fees, no contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Expired meds & vaccines	Pharmaceutical waste kit

Waste stream	The right path
Biohazard / RMW	Biohazard mail-back kit
Controlled substances	Controlled / medication kit (Form 41)

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back is the fastest path for most offices. Higher volume or a multi-provider group? We'll size a custom program — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY PHYSICIAN OFFICES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your physician office waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop